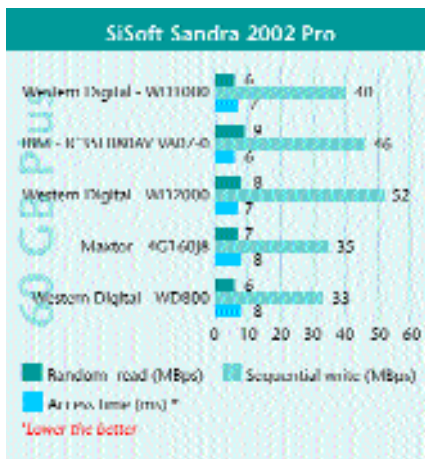


5

Tips to Keep your Drive Shipshape



- Protect the drive from shocks and jerks.
- Always handle the drive by its side. Never touch the underside of the drive or the drive electronics.
- When installing the hard drive, take care to screw it firmly to the chassis of the computer so as to protect the drive from vibrations when using the PC. The maximum damage that a drive suffers is usually due to improper handling during installation. Also take care to use the screws that come with the hard drive so that they match the bore size on the drive.
- Never try to open a hard disk if it fails to respond. Even a particle of dust entering the insides of the drive can destroy the platter on the disk.
- Enable S.M.A.R.T. from the BIOS. This slows the drive down, but the difference is hardly noticeable for most applications—between 2 to 5 per cent. S.M.A.R.T. is a technology that warns you when there is a problem and the drive is about to fail.



WD2000. It logged 54 MBps—one of the fastest scores we've ever logged for a 7,200-rpm drive. The drive that performed poorly here was the Western Digital WD800. It logged just 33 MBps—a tad slow for a 7,200-rpm drive. The 5,400-rpm drive that did well in the sequential read test was the Samsung

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SV1204H, with a score of 38 MBps.

The 82.3 GB IBM drive logged the fastest random read score of 9 MBps. The two drives that didn't do well in this test were the 80 GB Western Digital WD800 and the 100 GB Western Digital WD1000. Both these 7,200-rpm drives logged just 6 MBps.

In the sequential write tests, the formidable 200 GB Western Digital WD 2000 logged 52 MBps—the highest we have ever seen in an IDE hard disk drive. The 82.3 GB IBM drive also did well with a score of 46 MBps. Lagging in this test was the 80 GB Western Digital WD800, with a score of just 33 MBps.

The drive that exhibited a very good random write score was the 100 GB Western Digital WD1000 with a score of 14 MBps. Lagging here was the 80 GB Samsung SP8004H with a score of just 7 MBps. In the 5,400 range, the drive that did well was the 160 GB Maxtor drive with a score of 11 MBps while the two that trailed in this test were the 5,400-rpm 80 GB and 120 GB drives from Samsung, both logging just 5 MBps.

As for the access time test, the IBM drive delivered a stellar score of 6 ms, while the 120 GB 5,400-rpm Samsung drive lagged with a score of 10 ms.